OFFICEAIM KNOWLEDGE BASE: GTM STRATEGIST

1. THE NORTH STAR METRIC (NSM)

A successful GTM strategy hinges on tracking the right metric. Never track vanity metrics (registered users, logins, pageviews). Track "Core Value Events".

- *Bad NSM:* "Daily Active Logins."
- *Good NSM:* "Weekly Activated Users who completed 3 tasks and shared a workspace." Productivity and SaaS apps die when they measure intent instead of value delivered.

2. THE 5 GTM PHASES

- **Phase 0 (Market Thesis):** Define the beachhead segment. Set up tracking (Mixpanel, Amplitude). Define the positioning one-liner.
- **Phase 1 (Validation):** 30-50 customer interviews. Test willingness to pay. Track Time-to-Value (TTV).
- **Phase 2 (Closed Beta):** Invite-only (200-1,000 users). Goal is to prove D7 (Day 7) and Week 4 retention. Fix friction in onboarding.
- **Phase 3 (Public Launch):** Launch on Product Hunt, targeted subreddits, and newsletters. Shift focus from retention to scalable acquisition (CAC).
- **Phase 4 (Growth & Monetization):** Activate Product-Led Growth (PLG) loops. Test freemium limits. Optimize LTV:CAC to a 3:1 ratio.

3. THE 3 LAUNCH APPROACHES

1. **Big Bang (PR + Paid):** High risk. Best when PMF is already strong and budget is meaningful. Wastes momentum if retention is poor.
2. **Niche Beachhead:** Best for B2B/Productivity. Target one specific community (e.g., "Agency Project Managers"). High activation, clear positioning.
3. **Exclusive Closed Beta:** Invite-only. Best for products needing heavy iteration. Builds FOMO (Fear Of Missing Out) and strong case studies.

4. CRITICAL STARTUP KPIs TO TRACK

- **TTV (Time To Value):** Minutes/hours until the user experiences the product's core promise.
- **Activation Rate:** % of signups who hit the core value event in 24-72 hours.
- **D7 Retention:** % of users who return on Day 7. (Consumer/SaaS: 25% is okay, 40%+ is great).
- **LTV:CAC:** Lifetime Value to Customer Acquisition Cost ratio. Target is 3:1 or higher.
- **Payback Period:** How many months it takes to recover CAC. Aim for < 6-12 months.

- **NRR (Net Revenue Retention):** Revenue retained from existing customers (including upsells/cross-sells). Target 100-120%+.